

Basics of International Relations

Foreign Policy: Foreign policy is the mechanism national governments use to guide their diplomatic interactions and relationships with other countries. A state's foreign policy reflects its values and goals, and helps drive its political and economic aims in the global arena.

Purpose:

1. Protecting India's sovereignty and territorial integrity.
2. Ensuring better relations With India's neighbours and global partners
3. Protecting and expanding India's interests
4. Aiding rapid socio-economic development
5. Taking care of Indians and people of Indian origin living abroad (diaspora).
6. Achieving India's due position in the comity of nations

Determinants of Indian Foreign Policy:

Permanent determinants: Geography, history, Culture and traditions.

Transformational determinants: Nature and degree of economic development, Personality of top leadership, Domestic milieu, Ideological orientations of a given government.

Factors influencing India's Foreign Policy:

Geographical Factors: Geographical factors refer to the shape, size, geophysical peculiarities, resource endowments and surrounding geopolitical environment of a country. Natural boundaries like the Himalayas and oceans provide veritable defence to India from inimical forces. Strategic location of India is further strengthened by the long coastline that surrounds the country from east, west and south. They make her pivot of global politics and trade in the Indian Ocean region.

Economic Factors: Economic factors include natural resources such as metal, minerals, fossil fuels, fertile land, water, human resources and use of all these endowments to achieve and maintain a high rate of economic growth for the country. The significance of these factors have attained critical proportions in the wake of privatization, liberalization and globalization. India has sufficient endowment of various natural resources barring a few such as fossil fuels, uranium and precious metal such as gold. Besides, India has a favourable demographic profile.

Historical and Cultural Factors: India is one of the few countries in the world with ancient civilization, and rich historical and cultural legacy. At the same time, around two hundred years of colonial rule, and a long and chequered history of national movement also provide valuable inputs to the shaping of Indian foreign policy. Anti-colonialism, anti-imperialism, anti-apartheid, solidarity with the cause of Afro-Asian nations, support for United Nations endeavors etc. are some of the running themes of national movement that remain ingrained in the foreign policy of the country even today.

Cultural ideals like vasudhaiv kutumbkam and Swami Vivekananda's exhortation of taking all the people as our brothers and sisters still resonate in the conduct of Indian foreign policy. Gandhian paradigms of satyagraha, ahimsa and swadeshi are taken as cardinal principles of Indian foreign policy since its very inception.

Domestic Milieu: India's mammoth social and cultural diversity and democratic traditions is one of its unique selling points in international politics. Democracy has been central to engagements with the west. Having a large population of Muslims has helped in maintaining close relations with predominantly Islamic nations. Conversely, the Islamic dimension has enabled India to develop a fairly

in depth understanding of the Muslim world. Politics of Tamil Nadu always remain a determining factor in India's relations with Sri Lanka. Bengali bhadralok of West Bengal acts as the bedrock of India's relations with Bangladesh.

But at times, this also creates challenges. For instance, a major cause of India's discomfiture in its misadventure in Sri Lanka in 1987 was the opposition of that move by the people of Tamil Nadu.

Persona of the Leadership: Persona of the leadership also arguably plays a very important role in formulation of a decisive foreign policy of a country. Jawaharlal Nehru's idealistic vision and utopian perspective of India's relations with her neighbours not only cost her dearly in terms of loss in India-China war but also produced a number of perennial problems such as Kashmir. On the contrary, Indira Gandhi's resolute leadership not only won India her war with mischievous Pakistan but also earned all weather friends like Soviet Union and made India a nuclear country to be feared by its inimical forces.

Ideological Predilections: Ideological predilection means the implicit or explicit commitment of a leader to a particular ideology. Given Nehru's overt inclination towards socialist ideology, Indian foreign policy during his stewardship had socialist underpinnings. In recent times, given the ideological orientation of leadership towards free market capitalism, a marked tilt in the Indian foreign policy towards the United States and other capitalist countries are quite apparent. Thus, ideological predilections of political leadership have always been one of the determining factors of Indian foreign policy.

International Scenario: Apart from the internal dynamics of a country, external or international scenario play important role in determining the nature and thrust of foreign policy of a country.

In India, the dynamics of cold war was the key factor behind the policy of non-alignment. Similarly, given its penchant for peace and non-violence, India would have never gone for wars with Pakistan and China to settle its issues with them. But it was forced by its belligerent neighbours to fight wars with them at different points of time. In the same vein, had China not exploded its nuclear bomb in 1964, it would have been beyond imagination of Indian foreign and security establishments to reorient peaceful nuclear program of the country towards explosion of nuclear devices.

Institutions of Foreign Policy making

Parliament

1. India's Parliament (Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha) has the power to legislate on foreign affairs, one of the subjects in the exclusive domain of the central/union government.
2. This authority includes legislation or amendment of any law for the successful implementation of international treaties, agreements and conventions.
3. Government is accountable to Parliament, which can seek information and clarification on policies and issues.
4. Theoretically, by exercising budgetary control and passing necessary resolutions, Parliament can force the executive to act as per the will of the Government.

Generally, parliament contributes to making of the foreign policy of India in three ways:

1. Firstly, while debating the decisions of government, members of parliament articulate different perspectives on the subject. Thus, parliamentary debates tend to articulate the wider range of public opinion on a given policy decision of the government.

N: Alliance
Strategic
Autonomy
Unipolar
USSR
x
Russia

executive
legislative
Judicial

2. Secondly, on occasions, parliament also acts to suggest modifications in a particular policy decision of the government. Though such suggestions have very less chance of getting through the house, they, nonetheless, make government aware of feelings of the members on the issue.
3. Finally, when parliament accords its approval to the policy decisions of the government, such decisions become consensual approach of the country towards a given subject and tend to carry much more weight. Thus, though parliament plays only indirect role in the making of India's foreign policy, that role is unquestionably quite eminent.

The Cabinet

The Cabinet being the top most decision making body of the government, determines the course of India's external relations by giving necessary directions.

Ministry of External Affairs

A look at the 'Allocation of Business Rules' of GOI shows that MEA has been empowered with the task of planning, formulating and managing India's external relations with other nations to protect and promote national interests in the global stage. MEA is headed by the Minister of External Affairs on the political side and Foreign Secretary on the administrative side.

MEA acts like the foreign policy secretariat in India, which receives numerous policy inputs from various sources, and analyzes and channelizes the different options to the political leadership, i.e., the Cabinet headed by the PM, and then implements decisions taken at this apex level. Thus, MEA is the pivot around which the foreign policy making of India revolves.

The PMO

Under the Parliamentary form of government, Prime Minister is the executive head of the government. The PMO consisting of senior level bureaucrats provides secretarial assistance and advice to the PM and functions as the centre of policy making in India. It coordinates various central agencies like the Cabinet, Cabinet Committees, Council of Ministers and other stakeholders to sort out interdepartmental hurdles in domestic and foreign policy execution.

Insofar as making of foreign policy is concerned, PMO gets to play a more active role especially during the reign of activist Prime Ministers. Even in routine course of action, the policy decisions taken by the MEA are presented before the PMO for perusal and approval of the Prime Minister in case he does not have any modifications to suggest in those policies.

The foreign policy initiatives evolved by MEA come to their final shape only when they get approval from the Prime Minister. Thus, PMO happens to be the critical agency that provides finality to the foreign policy initiatives.

National Security Advisor

Intelligence - security domain

PM-Head.

Prime Minister's take on the matters of foreign policy is generally determined by the inputs provided by National Security Advisor (NSA). NSA is the secretary of the National Security Council (NSC) (created in 1998), which is headed by the Prime Minister. The NSA remains in touch with the Prime Minister one on one to keep him abreast of the latest happenings inside and outside the country.

Think Tanks:

oof input.

Think tanks are non-governmental, non-profit organisations engaged in study and research on different aspects of India's strategic and foreign affairs. They publish occasional research papers and policy briefs to make policy interventions in the formulation of foreign policy of the country. Staffed by professional researchers as well as former diplomats and practitioners of strategic and foreign affairs of the country, these think tanks carry the unique blend of theory and practice of foreign affairs. These organisations are also roped in by the government to act as the co-sponsors of important policy dialogues such as Raisina Dialogue on strategic and foreign policies of India.

Inputs are also taken from state governments, National Security Council, NGOs, Pressure Groups, and Interest Groups etc.

Continuity and Changes in Indian foreign Policy

Continuity

unilateral nation

many key of powers

cold war - bi polar.
USA - Unipolar.

1. Support for multilateralism, multipolarity and collective security.
2. Commitment to peaceful and rule based international order
3. Increasing India's stakes and India's profile at the global level.
4. Commitment to nuclear disarmament
5. Peaceful and strong relation with the neighbours
6. Pacifism and support to diplomacy for dispute resolution

nuclear proliferation

शक्तिवाद

Changes

leadership, external environment

Eco/Political Profile.

1. India's policy has shifted from Non-Alignment to Strategic Autonomy.
2. Deepening relations with the US and the West while remaining engaged with other players.
3. Greater focus on economic diplomacy
4. India becoming a reluctant nuclear power
5. Greater focus on diaspora
6. Military action to impose cost on adversaries.
7. Shift from Idealism to Pragmatism

strategic decision making

क्षेत्रवाद

Key inflexion points In Indian Foreign Policy

- **India's independence:** India became responsible for its relations with other nations. Prior to independence it was being controlled by the British government.
- **Establishment of NAM:** NAM is the largest organization outside the UN. It provided India with leadership of the 3rd world in a bipolar world. Through the platform of NAM, India advocated for decolonisation, anti-apartheid, nuclear disarmament etc.

1st liberal
western
world

2nd communist
order

3rd post-colonial world

- **War with China:** The war in 1962, where India was comprehensively defeated, was a setback for India's idealism and Hindi Chini Bhai-Bhai. It resulted in a freeze in relationship with China which only opened in late 1980s. Lack of support from any of the NAM members was a reality check for India. This also led to strengthening of China-Pakistan relations.
- **War with Pakistan- 1971:** This changed the geography of the subcontinent with the creation of Bangladesh. It ended the two-front threat from Pakistan and emergence of India as a decisive military power. India also signed Indo-Soviet Treaty of Friendship and Cooperation leading to deepening of India Russia relations. *look east Policy economic dimension*
- **Economic liberalization:** India's 1991 economic crisis and subsequent reforms led to India's emergence as a major economic power. It also resulted in deeper engagements with the West based on economic engagements and diversification of Indian diplomacy.
- **Collapse of USSR:** This resulted shift from bipolarity to a unipolar world. India also opened up its diplomatic engagements through Look East Policy and shifted from Non-Alignment to Strategic Autonomy.
- **Nuclear Test:** India conducting Pokharan II tests in May 1998 made India a de facto nuclear power and provided ultimate deterrence against nuclear China. It led to emergence of a more confident India who could withstand western pressure in its national interest. But it led to nuclearisation of Pakistan and concerns about nuclear exchange in the sub-continent. *instilling doubt or fear of consequence*
- **Civil Nuclear agreement with USA:** After nuclear tests, India engaged with the USA which led to removal of sanctions. Furthermore, Civil Nuclear Agreement was the beginning of deeper US-India engagements, Indian civil nuclear program under IAEA. India also got NSG waiver which opened up civil nuclear commerce for India.

Some common terms:

- **Track 1 dialogue/diplomacy:** Formal diplomacy. Between governments, diplomats and military leadership.
- **Track 1.5 dialogue/diplomacy:** Combination of formal and informal diplomacy. Eg.- Raisina dialogues *conference*
- **Track 2 dialogue/diplomacy:** ~~Back-channel~~ diplomacy mainly to avoid media attraction and arrive at consensus over contentious issues. *Not media*
- **Track 3 dialogue/diplomacy:** People to People engagements.
- **Para diplomacy:** Para diplomacy is conducted by sub-state governments. It introduces the idea of decentralisation of political power to make regional governments prominent actors in the international sphere. *Think Tank*
- **Public diplomacy:** Also called as people's diplomacy, is any of various government sponsored efforts aimed at communicating directly with foreign public. Public diplomacy includes all official efforts to convince targeted sectors of foreign opinion to support or tolerate a government strategic objective.



India-Pakistan Relations

The partition of British India created India and Pakistan alongside displacement up to 12.5 million people and an estimated loss of life of 1 million. India became a secular nation with a Hindu majority population and a large Muslim minority, while Pakistan emerged as an Islamic republic with an overwhelming Muslim majority population and a very small population subscribing to other faiths.

First India Pakistan war (1947-48): Armed Pakistani tribesmen aided by the newly created Pakistani Army invade Jammu & Kashmir in October 1947. The ruler of the State of Jammu & Kashmir, Maharaja Hari Singh, faced with internal revolt as well as an external invasion, requested the assistance of the Indian armed forces and agreed to accede to India. After signing of instrument of accession, India intervened in Jammu & Kashmir.

Second India-Pakistan War (1965): Began on 5th August 1965 with 25-30,000 Pakistani troops dressed as locals crossed over to the Indian side of LoC with the aim of instigating an insurgency among locals in Kashmir (**Operation Gibraltar**) but was unsuccessful as Kashmiri locals reported about the infiltrators.

In response to Pakistan's **Operation Grand Slam** aimed at capturing the critical Jammu town of Akhnoor, On 6th Sept 1965, India opened a new front by officially crossing the Radcliff line in Punjab and captured certain areas of Lahore. The war ended on 23rd Sept 1965 after the UNSC called for an unconditional ceasefire following diplomatic intervention by the Soviet Union and the United States.

Ceasefire negotiation was hosted by the USSR in Tashkent in January 1966 which led to the signing of **Tashkent Agreement**. The agreement compelled India and Pakistan to return the annexed areas to each other.

Third India-Pakistan War 1971: The genesis of war was in tensions between East and West Pakistan over refusal of premiership to Sheikh Mujibur Rahman after 1970 elections, **Pakistan Army atrocities on East Pakistan people** and **refugee influx in India**. India became involved in the conflict in December, after the Pakistani Air Force launched a pre-emptive strike on airfields in India's northwest. India retaliated with a coordinated land, air and sea assault on East Pakistan. The war ended with surrender of more than 90,000 Pakistani soldiers and liberation of Bangladesh.

Shimla Agreement: Signed between Indira Gandhi, Prime Minister of India and Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, President of Pakistan on 2nd July, 1972.

1. UN Charter to govern the relations between both nations.
2. In Jammu and Kashmir, the cease-fire line of December 17, 1971 was converted into Line of Control.
3. Both nations to resolve differences by peaceful means through bilateral negotiations. Pending final settlement, neither side shall unilaterally alter the situation.
4. Both nations shall always respect each other's national unity, territorial integrity, political independence and sovereign equality.
5. To restore and normalise relations between both countries, steps to resume communications, promote travel facilities and trade and cooperation in other agreed fields.

Kargil Conflict (1999): In May 1999, the Kargil conflict broke out when Pakistani forces intruded and occupied strategic positions on the Indian side of the LoC, prompting an Indian counter offensive in which Pakistani forces were pushed back to their side of the original LoC.

Coalition gov of india

Dec 1971 (3rd-16)

Key areas of dispute between India and Pakistan

Kashmir Issue:

During independence and partition, Jammu and Kashmir was a princely state ruled by Maharaja Hari Singh, a Hindu ruler in a Muslim-majority princely state. He did not want to merge with either India or Pakistan.

Maharaja Hari Singh tried to negotiate with India and Pakistan to have an independent status for his state. He offered a proposal of **Standstill Agreement** to both the Dominion, pending a final decision on State's accession. On August 12, 1947, the Prime Minister of Jammu and Kashmir sent identical communications to the Government of India and Pakistan.



Pakistan accepted the offer. India advised the Maharaja to send his authorized representative to Delhi for further discussion on the offer.

However, Pakistan broke the Standstill Agreement by sponsoring a Pashtun tribal militia and irregular Pakistani forces (Operation Gulmarg) to take over the capital city of Srinagar in October 1947.

Maharaja Hari Singh asked India for assistance. India assured help on condition Hari Singh should sign the Instrument of Accession. Maharaja Hari Singh signed the **Instrument of Accession** with India guaranteeing limited access to India in Jammu and Kashmir—on matters of defence, communications and foreign affairs.

On 1 January 1948, PM Nehru formally took the Jammu and Kashmir issue to the United Nations Security Council.

The UN Security Council passed resolution 39 (1948) and established the **United Nations Commission for India and Pakistan (UNCIP)** to investigate the issues and mediate between the two countries. Following the cease-fire, it also established the **United Nations Military Observer Group in India and Pakistan (UNMOGIP)** to monitor the cease-fire line.

The UN Security Council passed Resolution 47 on 21 April 1948 which recommended a **three-step process for the resolution of the dispute**.

1. In the first step, Pakistan was asked to withdraw all its nationals that entered Kashmir for the sake of fighting.
2. In the second step, India was asked to progressively reduce its forces to the minimum level required for law and order.
3. In the third step, India was asked to appoint a plebiscite administrator nominated by the United Nations who would conduct a free and impartial plebiscite.

However, the plebiscite could never take place. It also resulted in 1965 war. Later on, after Shimla agreement, both sides agreed to solve the issue bilaterally.

Significance of Kashmir:

- **Ideologically:** Linked to two-nation theory and Muslim-majority identity of Kashmir.
- **Geographically:** Sandwiched between China and Pakistan.
- **Economically:** Water resources because Indus Rive System passes through the region and Pakistan's agrarian economy is dependent on it.

- Pakistan Army has continued its hegemony over Pakistan population on the ground of taking back Kashmir from India.

On 05th 2019, India amended Ar. 370 and divided the state of Jammu and Kashmir into two Union territories of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh. After that, Pakistan suspended bilateral trade, banning all imports and exports to and from India. It has asked India to resume the special status of Jammu and Kashmir. Pakistan has also been raking up Kashmir issue at various international fora, but of limited avail.

Kashmir Insurgency:

After losing in three consecutive wars with India along with loss of East Pakistan, Pakistan resorted to low intensity warfare under the "Bleeding India through a Thousand Cuts" of Pakistan's General Zia-ul-Haq. Pakistan began proxy war and insurgency first in Punjab and then in Jammu and Kashmir.

In 1987, a disputed state election in Jammu and Kashmir acted as a catalyst for the insurgency when it resulted in some of the state's legislative assembly members forming armed insurgent groups. In July 1988, a series of demonstrations, strikes and attacks took place. In 1989, a widespread popular and armed insurgency, supported tacitly from across the border started. It was supported by Afghan Mujahideen who entered the Kashmir valley following the end of the Soviet-Afghan war.

Terror groups like **Jammu & Kashmir Liberation Front (JKLF)**, **Hizbul Mujahideen**, **Lashker-e-Taiba**, **Jaish-e-Mohammed**, **Al-Badar**, **Harkatul-Ansar**, **Harkat-ul-Jihad-e-Islami (Huji)** emerged, directly supported, funded and provided training, weapons, etc. by **Pakistan's intelligence agency ISI and the government of Pakistan**.

Separatist leaders continuously called for shut downs and boycott of elections. However, since 2008 state elections, voter turnout has been high and elections largely peaceful, seen as yearning for peace and harmony by Kashmiri people.

Siachen

Siachen Glacier is a piedmont glacier located at more than 5000 mt. Above sea level in the Karakoram range between Saltoro ridge to the west and the main Karakoram range to the east. It is the second longest nonpolar glacier in the world, after Fedchenko Glacier in Tajikistan.

Both India and Pakistan claimed some sovereignty over entire region due to lack of clarity beyond point NJ9842. In 1984, India launched **Operation Meghdoot** to take control of Siachen Glaciers. India had pre-empted Pakistan's **Operation Ababeel** by just one day to occupy the heights on **Saltoro Ridge**.

India exercises control over the 70-kilometre-long Siachen Glacier and its tributary glaciers, as well as all the main passes and heights of the Saltoro Ridge immediately west of the glacier, including Sia La, Bilafond La, and Gyong La. Pakistan controls the glacial valleys immediately west of the Saltoro Ridge.



Both nations have tried to arrive at resolution multiple times but failed due to lack of mutual trust. While Pakistan demands the glacier to be demilitarised first, the Indian army demands authentication of the positions first.

1989
Soviet
Leave Afghani

Significance of Siachen Glacier:

- **Location:** Strategically located at height with Pakistan on one side and China on the other side.
- It overlooks Gilgit-Baltistan region of PoK, giving strategic advantage to India in times of war.
- It guards the routes leading to Leh, the capital city of Ladakh.
- it overlooks and dominates the **Shaksgam Valley**, which was illegally ceded to China by Pakistan.
- It is close to the **Karakoram Pass** through which the **Karakoram Highway** passes connecting Gilgit-Baltistan to Xinjiang Province of China.
- **Water resources:** Sources of multiple rivers for irrigation and hydro-power purpose. Nubra river, a tributary of Shyok river, originated from the glacier.

Sir Creek

- Sir Creek is a 96-km strip of water disputed between India and Pakistan in the Rann of Kutch marshlands.
- The dispute lies in the interpretation of the maritime boundary line between Kutch and Sindh.
- Pakistan claims the entire creek as per paragraphs 9 and 10 of the **Bombay Government Resolution of 1914**



- signed between then the Government of Sindh and Rao Maharaj of Kutch.
- But India claims that the boundary lies mid-channel as depicted in another map drawn in 1925, and implemented by the installation of mid-channel pillars back in 1924.
- According to international law and the **Thalweg principle**, a boundary can only be fixed in the middle of the navigable channel, which meant that it has been divided between Sindh and Kutch, and thereby India and Pakistan.
- After the 1965 war, British Prime Minister Harold Wilson successfully persuaded both countries to end hostilities and set up a tribunal to resolve the dispute.
- The verdict of the tribunal came in 1968 which saw Pakistan getting 10% of its claim of 9,000 km (3,500 sq. miles).
- Since 1969, 12 rounds of talks have been held over the issue of Sir Creek, but both sides have denied reaching any solution.

Significance of Sir Creek:

- It is an important fishing ground and is one of the largest fishing sources in Asia.
- Possibility of presence of oil and gas reserves under the sea shelf of the region. The area is unexplored due to boundary dispute.
- Fishermen frequently crossing to the other side and get caught by the respective navies.

Indus Water Treaty

- The treaty regulates the use the water available in Indus River and its tributaries. Considered as one of the most successful water sharing endeavors in the world today.



- The Indus water treaty was brokered by the World Bank and signed in 1960.
- The treaty gives control over the waters of the three eastern rivers Beas, Ravi and Satluj to India, while control over the waters of three western rivers Indus, Chenab and Jhelum to Pakistan.
- India has about **20% of total water** carried by the Indus River System while **Pakistan has 80%.** India is allowed to use 20% water of the western rivers for irrigation, power generation and transport purposes and unlimited use for non-consumptive purpose.
- The treaty granted 3.6 million acre-feet (MAF) of “permissible storage capacity” to India on the western rivers but due to poor water development projects, 2-3 MAF of water easily flows into Pakistan.
- Permanent Indus Commission** for implementation and management of the treaty and resolution of any dispute.

Positives of the Treaty:

- Despite 3 wars, the treaty has been followed by both nations.
- The treaty is exhibited by the World Bank as most successful example of resolution of Interstate River water dispute.
- It also displays India's commitment to international agreements and obligations.

Issues:

- India has about 20% of the total water carried by the Indus system while Pakistan has 80%. It is among the most unequal treaties.
- Despite being the upper riparian state, India is at disadvantage. India itself has huge water scarcity, that can be addressed by utilizing water of the Indus River System.
- Pakistan has not been able to utilise the water and it gets wasted by flowing into the sea.
- Pakistan has used the treaty to delay India's hydroelectric power projects like Salal and Baglihar.
- Jammu and Kashmir has complained about the lack of water and its irrigation needs. In 2003 and 2016, Jammu & Kashmir assembly demanded abrogation and revision of the treaty respectively.
- Due to climate change (5% decrease in flow since 1960), advancement in water storage and management techniques, expanding agriculture and population, there has been increase in demand of water.
- Due to Pakistan's continuous involvement in terrorism, there has been a domestic demand to scrap the treaty.

In News: India sends notice for amending IWT

- On 25th January, India issued notice to Pakistan for amending the Indus Water Treaty 1960 under **Article XII (3) of the treaty**.
- Ar. XII (3): The provisions of the treaty may from time-to-time be modified by a duly ratified treaty concluded for the purpose between the two governments.
- The Notice gives Pakistan 90 days to enter into Inter-governmental negotiations to rectify violations of the treaty. India aims to update the treaty since situation has changed in last 62 years.

20% of water

Challenges with unilateral abrogation of the treaty:

- Abrogation might be difficult, mainly due to India's international obligations and treaties.
- India has not utilized its full rights either over Eastern or Western Rivers.
- Abrogation might lead to increase in tensions. China can become a party to any future negotiation.
- Other lower riparian neighbours of India like Bangladesh might become anxious.

Terrorism:

Timeline:

- Use of tribals along with its army in 1947-48.
- Sneaking in its forces during 1965 to create discontent in the valley for uprising.
- Use of Mujaheddin in Afghanistan to defeat USSR. Then same technique used to destabilise and internationalise Kashmir.

Bleed India with a thousand cuts:

In a 1965 speech to the UN Security Council, Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, the then Foreign Minister of Pakistan, declared a thousand-year war against India. Pakistani Army Chief General Zia-ul-Haq gave form to Bhutto's "thousand years war" with the 'bleeding India through a thousand cuts' doctrine using covert and low-intensity warfare with militancy and infiltration. This doctrine was first attempted during the Punjab insurgency and then in Kashmir insurgency using India's western border with Pakistan. India's borders with Nepal and Bangladesh have also been used as points to insert trained militants into the country.

Nuclearization of South Asia (1998):

India detonated five nuclear devices on 11 and 13 May 1998 at the Pokhran range in Rajasthan desert. Pakistan responded by detonating six nuclear devices on 28 May, 1998 at Ras Koh Hills in the Chaghai district of Balochistan. The tests resulted in international sanctions being placed on both countries. Both countries became the newest Nuclear-armed nations.

15 days they are also building have to review.

Timeline of important events and initiatives

Composite Bilateral Dialogue:

In 1998, a Composite Dialogue with eight subjects was started between India and Pakistan. This was the first-time reference of "all outstanding issues including Jammu and Kashmir" was mentioned.

The dialogue had eight subjects:

- Siachen - to be handled by the defence secretary.

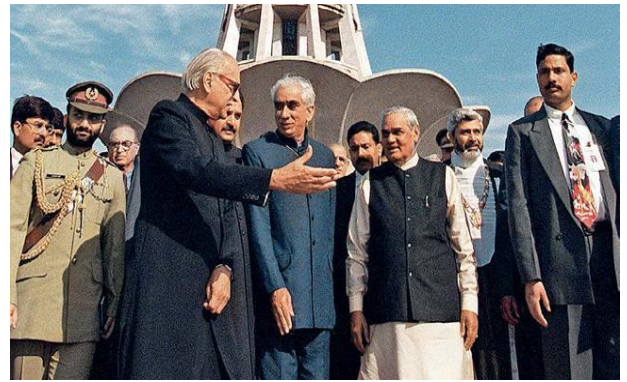
2. Sir Creek - to be handled by surveyor general or additional secretary defence.
3. Tulbul navigation project - to be handled by secretary water resources.
4. Terrorism and drug trafficking - to be handled by home secretary.
5. Economic and commercial cooperation - to be handled by commerce secretary.
6. Promotion of friendly exchanges - to be handled by secretary culture.
7. Peace and security including CBMs - to be handled by foreign secretary.
8. Jammu and Kashmir - under the foreign secretary.

*Technocrats.
divided the problem
give to certain
ministry.*

Indo-Pak Bus Diplomacy (February 1999):



PM Vajpayee in bus to Lahore



PM Vajpayee at Minar-e-Pakistan

Indian Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee travelled by bus to Lahore to meet Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif. The two signed the Lahore Declaration, the first major agreement between the two countries since the 1972 Shimla Agreement. Both countries reiterated that they remained committed to the Shimla Agreement, and agreed to undertake a number of Confidence Building Measures (CBMs) aimed at improving bilateral relations. Mutual understanding was reached towards the development of atomic arsenals and to avoid accidental and unauthorised operational use of nuclear weapons.

During his visit to the Minar-e-Pakistan, PM Vajpayee wrote in the visitor's book there: "A stable, secure and prosperous Pakistan is in India's interest. Let no one in Pakistan be in doubt. India sincerely wishes Pakistan well."

However, before the efforts could bear fruits, both nations were engaged in Kargil conflict between May-July 1999, as a result of infiltrators backed by Pakistan Army occupied the strategic heights along the border regions of Jammu and Kashmir.

In December 1999, Air India plane IC-814 was hijacked (Kandahar Hijack) during its flight from Kathmandu to New Delhi. India was forced to release three jailed terrorists including Masood Azhar to ensure safe release of hostages.

Agra Summit (2001):

In July, Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee and Pakistan President Pervez Musharraf met for a two-day summit in Agra. At the meeting, a proposal was made to drastically reduce nuclear arsenals and to resolve

Taliban rule

other issues involving the Kashmir dispute, and cross-border terrorism. However, the negotiations broke down and the process was collapsed so the Agra treaty was never signed. Sushma Swaraj said it failed as Musharraf was adamant on discussing Kashmir issue first.

In October 2001, in an attack on Jammu & Kashmir Legislative Assembly, 38 people were killed. Following that attack, Farooq Abdullah, the chief minister of Jammu & Kashmir called on the Indian government to launch a full-scale military operation against the training camps in Pakistan. Furthermore, on 13 December 2001, an armed attack on the Indian parliament in New Delhi left 14 people dead. LeT and JeM were held responsible for the attacks.

India launched Operation Parakram mobilising almost 800,000 troops. The mobilisation was slow, allowing Pakistan to counter-mobilise its own troops, escalating the risk of a full-fledged war between two nuclear powers. The standoff ended only in October 2002, after international mediation.

2004-05: Discussion on composite dialogue resumed.

2008: 26/11 Mumbai Terror attack took place. More than 160 people were killed in the attacks. In the wake of the attacks, India broke off talks with Pakistan.

2010 - Talks started again and it was named "resumed dialogue" instead of composite dialogue. There were minor differences from the composite dialogue, as this time it included counter terrorism, including Mumbai attack trials and humanitarian issues, which was to be overseen by the home secretary.

2014 – All SAARC nations' leaders including Pak PM were invited to the inauguration of the Modi government. Prime Minister Narendra Modi held talks with Pakistan's Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif and both sides express willingness to begin a new era of bilateral relations.

2015: In December 2015, both nations agreed to start Comprehensive Bilateral Dialogue on issues including Peace and Security, CBMs, Jammu & Kashmir, Siachen, Sir Creek, Wullar Barrage/Tulbul Navigation Project, Economic and Commercial Cooperation, Counter-Terrorism, Narcotics Control, Humanitarian Issues, People to People exchanges and religious tourism.

Currently, the dialogue process is in limbo since India has clearly said that **talks and terror cannot go together**. It has asked for Pakistan to make the environment conducive for dialogues by preventing cross border terrorism. Since the change in status of Jammu and Kashmir, Pakistan has called for revoking the amendment to article 370 for continuation of any bilateral relations.

Pathan Kot Attacks

ISI Joint investigation

2016: In the aftermath of Uri attacks, India launched "surgical strikes" on terror launch pads in PoK.

2019: In the early hours of February 26, India conducts air attacks against Jaish-e-Mohammad (JeM)'s training camp in Balakot resulting in a brief air skirmish. An India pilot was captured and subsequently released.

On 5th August 2019, India changed the status of Jammu and Kashmir. In response, Pakistan stopped all bilateral trade. But later on, permitted import of life saving drugs.

2021 Ceasefire: In February 2021, India and Pakistan agreed to abide by the 2003 ceasefire agreement. However, it has been violated by Pakistan over a dozen times in last two years.

Taliban
in power.

Pakistan's first National Security Policy

1. On 14 January 2022, Pakistan unveiled Pakistan's first National Security Policy (NSP), which purportedly focuses on the 'security of its citizens.' It stresses human security, geoeconomics, regional connectivity, prosperity, trade, and investment. It gives an impression of fresh new thinking from the Pakistani establishment.
2. It aims to define the country's security priorities between 2022 to 2026, including relations with India.
3. It mentions that 'Pakistan, under its policy of peace at home and abroad, wishes to improve its relationship with India.'

At **Islamabad Security Dialogue**, Ex- Army chief General Bajwa talked about shift from geopolitics to geoeconomics. He said that Pakistan was keen to 'bury the past and move forward'.

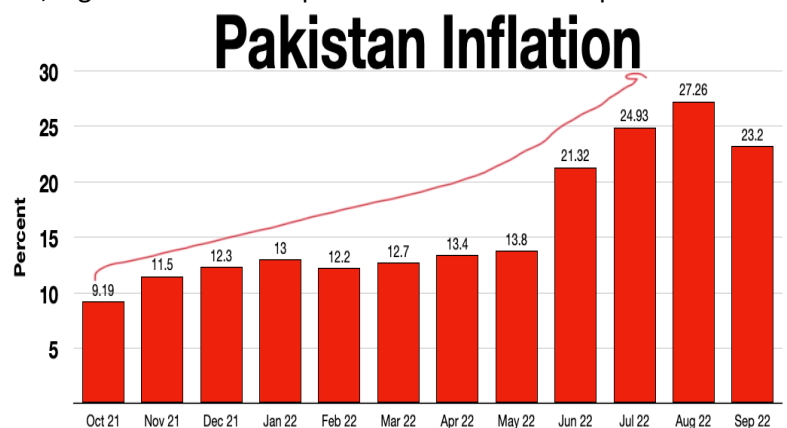
Political instability in Pakistan

Pakistan Army has continued to remain the most dominant player in Pakistan in its domestic as well as international affairs. This has resulted in periodic toppling of democratically elected leaders, **several decades** under military rule (1958–1971, 1977–1988, 1999 – 2008) and establishing politically-pliant regimes by the army.

In recent times, Imran Khan lost the vote of confidence in Pakistan Parliament and coming of Pakistan Democratic Movement (PDM) government led by Shehbaz Sharif to power. PTI led by Imran Khan began protests and demanded for new elections. This resulted in political turmoil. This has been further complicated by precarious economic situation, high inflation and depreciation of Pakistani rupee.

Pakistan's Economic Crisis:

Political instability along with unseasonal rains resulting in floods and damaging crops, high energy prices due to Ukraine crisis, high import dependence, lack of economic reforms and continued dependence on external aid & borrowings, high levels of debt & borrowing at high interest rates and depreciation in Pakistani rupee have resulted in ongoing economic crisis.



IMF programme has demanded the government to take deep cut in subsidies and social sector expenditure has further exacerbated the inflation scenario. In last 75 years, Pakistan has gone to the IMF for a record 23 times for bailouts. Argentina comes next with 21 programmes.

Bilateral trade: In 2014-15, highest at \$2.49 billion, with India enjoying significant surplus. Pakistan has banned the bilateral trade since amendment of status of Jammu and Kashmir by Indian Parliament. However, it has permitted the import of life-saving drugs from India.

Demerits of Trade ban:

- Limited impact on India, since It is a much bigger economy with diversified trade partners.

Impact on Pakistan

1. Goods have to be rerouted through UAE which increases the cost.
2. This has resulted in high inflation in Pakistan and drain of foreign exchange.
3. Increased input cost for Pakistani companies that are dependent on Indian raw materials, rendering them uncompetitive in global trade.

Thus, opening of trade will be more beneficial to Pakistan than to India.

Emerging challenges for India:

1. **China Pakistan Economic Corridor** passing through Pakistan occupied Kashmir increases stake for China to support Pakistan and strengthens China-Pakistan axis.
2. Pakistan has renewed attempts to internationalise Kashmir with support of China.
3. It has gone for adventurism by issuing new maps which includes whole of Jammu and Kashmir and other regions like Junagadh as part of Pakistan.
4. Pakistan economic crisis, political instability, high inflation poses challenge for India as Pakistan may go for misadventurism at the border to distract the public from domestic issues.
5. Increasing radicalization of Pakistan society, strengthening of groups like **Tahrik-e-labbaik** further pose challenge.
6. Trafficking of contraband drugs and weapons across the border to Punjab and Gujarat and via ships to Tamil Nadu and Kerala.
7. China's supply of frigates and other military assets to Pakistan, its port at Gwadar can pose challenge to India's vision of Net Security Provider in the region.
8. Control of Taliban over Afghanistan- Pakistan can use Afghanistan to train terrorists and foment trouble in India.
9. Pakistan getting closer to Russia.

Scope for Cooperation:

1. **Sanghai Cooperation Organisation**: Since both nations are members of SCO and terrorism and connectivity are its key agendas, both can cooperate under the platform.
2. **Kartarpur Corridor**- Opening of Kartarpur corridor proves possibility of people-to-people engagements reducing bilateral tensions.
3. Agreement on ceasefire at LOC in February 2021
4. Pakistan military chief talking about geoeconomics rather than geopolitics at inaugural Islamabad Security Dialogue ✕
5. Pakistan's recently unveiled National Security Policy has put economic security at the core of comprehensive national security.

f improving relation with India.

Afghanistan



Afghanistan is called as “graveyard of empires” and “land of great games.”

Modern history of Afghanistan:

1. Following the Third Anglo-Afghan War in 1919, Afghanistan became free of foreign dominance, and eventually emerged as the independent Kingdom of Afghanistan in June 1926 under Amanullah Khan.
2. This monarchy lasted almost 50 years, until Zahir Shah was overthrown in 1973. In 1973, while the King was in Italy, Daoud Khan launched a bloodless coup and became the first President of Afghanistan, abolishing the monarchy.
3. In April 1978, the communist People's Democratic Party of Afghanistan (PDPA) seized power in a bloody coup d'état against then-President Mohammed Daoud Khan, in what is called the **Saur Revolution**.
4. In 1989, Soviet withdrew from Afghanistan and in 1992, the communist government under **Mohammed Najibullah** collapsed.
5. Another civil war broke out after the creation of a dysfunctional coalition government between leaders of various mujahideen factions. In the infighting, Taliban emerged victorious and seized control of Afghanistan.
6. After 9/11 attacks, US Invaded Afghanistan Since Taliban regime refused to hand over **Osama bin Laden** to the US. This resulted in end of Taliban era and establishment of democratic regime in Afghanistan under **Hamid Karzai**.
7. After the imminent US withdrawal from Afghanistan, the Taliban got bolstered and started recapture of Afghanistan from Ashraf Ghani government. On 15th of August 2021, Taliban took over the control of Kabul. However, none of the nations till date have recognised the Taliban regime in Afghanistan.

Opposed
by
Northern
Allies

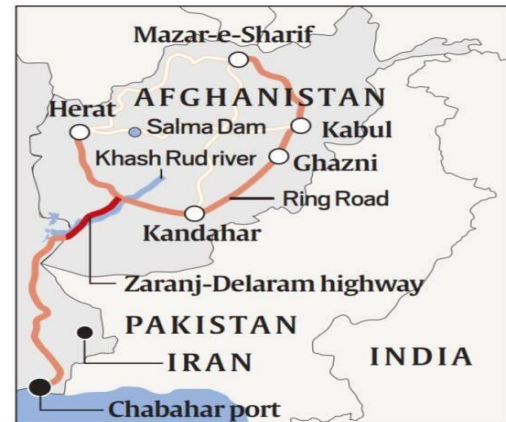
Quetta (Balochistan)

India Afghanistan Relations

India and Afghanistan have traditionally enjoyed a strong relationship based on historical and cultural links. India has played a significant role in the reconstruction and rehabilitation of Afghanistan.

The Republic of India was the only South Asian country to recognize the Soviet-backed Democratic Republic of Afghanistan in the 1980s, though relations were diminished during the 1990s Afghan civil war and the Taliban government. During Taliban regime, India didn't recognise it and rather supported the **Northern Alliance**.

India aided the overthrow of the Taliban by offering intelligence and other forms of support for the Coalition forces led by the USA in 2001. After the overthrow of the Taliban, India established diplomatic relations with the newly established democratic government, provided aid and participated in the reconstruction efforts. India has made key infrastructure projects like new Afghan parliament, Garland highway, Zaranj- Delaram Highway, Indira Gandhi Hospital, Salma dam (India Afghanistan Friendship dam) and has projects going in all the 34 provinces.



India is the biggest regional donor to Afghanistan and fifth largest donor globally with over \$3 billion in assistance. India has built over 200 public and private schools, sponsors over 1,000 scholarships, hosts over 16,000 Afghan students. Relations between Afghanistan and India received a major boost in 2011 with the signing of a Strategic Partnership Agreement.

Trade Relations: Bilateral trade in 2019-20 was around \$1.5 billion. As a **Least Developed Country (LDC)**, Afghanistan enjoys duty free access to Indian markets for Afghan products like dry fruits. Coming of Taliban has disrupted the trade. However, India has tried to ensure access through Chabahar port.

duty free

Challenge:

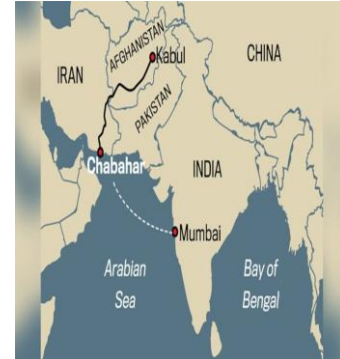
1. Pakistan unwillingness to provide overland route for trade.
2. Increased security concerns since coming of Taliban and Haqqani network's proximity with the ISI.
3. Fear of opium trade and narcotics trafficking within the Indian borders.
4. Limited engagement of India with Taliban create challenge for exploitation of abundant iron reserves (Hajigak) and copper deposits (Mes Ayank).

Military Relations: India provided military training to Afghan personnel and has supplied platforms like Mi 25 attack helicopters for Afghan forces. Since coming of Taliban, these corporations have been halted.

not Noce

Positives:

1. India enjoys huge soft power and acceptability among all Afghan tribes and common population.
2. India's development projects have brought noticeable difference to the life of common Afghans and Indian projects are ongoing in all the Afghan provinces. Taliban has asked India to complete the projects and has promised security to them.
3. Iran and Central Asian Republics have affirmed India's stake in the stability of Afghanistan during Delhi regional security dialogue.
4. Activation of Chabahar port and start of trade with Afghanistan and other Central Asian Republics through Chabahar provide opportunity for continued economic engagement.
5. Taliban has asked India to complete its developmental projects, underscoring India's constructive engagement in Afghanistan.



Current Challenges:

1. After Taliban takeover, India has evacuated its embassies. This has created challenges for the development works undertaken by India in Afghanistan. However, in June 2022, India reopened it with a small technical team. On the other hand, in October 2023, Afghan embassy in Delhi ceased its operations due to lack of resources and discord with Taliban regime.
2. Taliban takeover also provides ungoverned spaces for the terror groups like Laskar-e-Taiba and Jais-e-Mohammed to train and launch attacks against India.
3. Threat to the minorities in Afghanistan have created refugee crisis and India had to evacuate Hindu and Sikh minorities in Afghanistan.
4. Taliban's involvement in opium trade may also lead to illegal narcotics trafficking to India. There have been cases of containers filled with opium caught at the Mundra port.
5. Challenges emerging out of humanitarian crisis in Afghanistan, fear of ISIS and other terror groups activities in Afghanistan can destabilise the region as a whole.
6. Greater influence and control of Haqqani network in Taliban government and regime limits the scope for trust best relationship between India and Taliban.
7. At the **Delhi Regional Security Dialogue**, absence of Pakistan and China shows unwillingness of both these nations to accept India rule in Afghan affairs and stability.

Recent Initiatives:

Pragmatism

1. India has engaged with Taliban through its Doha office. Taliban has also showed eagerness towards Indian investment in Afghanistan and ask for India to continue them.
2. India has provided medical supplies and food to Afghanistan in the form of humanitarian assistance. India has bypassed Pakistan through Chabahar port in Iran.
3. It has also organised meeting of NSAs under **Delhi regional security dialogue on Afghanistan** to discuss the challenges emerging out of Taliban takeover of Afghanistan.
4. It has increased its engagement at highest level with Central Asian republics through **India Central Asia summit**.

Key points of Delhi declaration:

1. Afghanistan's territory should not be used for sheltering, training, planning or financing of any terrorist acts.
2. There should be cooperation against the menace of radicalisation, extremism, separatism and drug trafficking in the region.
3. There should be an open and truly inclusive government that represents the will of the people of Afghanistan.
4. The United Nations has a central role to play in Afghanistan, its continued presence must be preserved.

Ensuring that the fundamental rights of women, children and minority communities are not violated.

Pakistan factor in Afghanistan:

- During communist regime in Afghanistan and Soviet invasion of Afghanistan, Pakistan was the training ground for the mujahideen fighters who fought against the Soviet army.
- When first Taliban regime took over Kabul in 1996, Pakistan was one of the three nations recognizing it, other two being Saudi Arabia and the UAE.
- After fall of Taliban regime in 2001 and establishment of democratic Afghanistan, Taliban leaders found shelter in Quetta, under the protection of the ISI. Although Pakistan denied the claims.
- After fall of Kabul on 15th August 2021 by Afghan Taliban, Pakistani PM Imran Khan describing it as Afghans breaking "the shackles of slavery". ISI also played key role on ensuring peace between different factions and formation of Taliban government.
- Pakistan expected that the Taliban regime in Afghanistan would help it in having a pliable regime and handling TTP (Tehrik-e Taliban Pakistan). However, that has not materialized.
- Taliban regime has also not recognized the Durand line as the border, and has uprooted the fencing that has been put up by Pakistan to prevent infiltration. This has

made it easier for militants to cross the border, attack Pakistan and hide on the Afghanistan side of the border.

- The relations have further soured because of Pakistan's criticism of Taliban, Taliban's inability to bring TTP to the negotiation table and Pakistan sending back Afghan refugees. Taliban's willingness to engage with India is another factor.

China in Afghanistan:

Taliban has shown greater interest in engaging with China. In September 2023, China became the first nation to appoint an ambassador to Kabul. China has also talked about extending BRI to Afghanistan. Taliban has also expressed interest in formally joining the same. China is also interested in vast untapped mineral wealth in Afghanistan. China-Pakistan axis makes it more convenient for China to engage in Afghanistan. This would limit the diplomatic space available for India.

China's interests in Afghanistan:

- Tackling the threat posed by Turkestan Islamic Party (TIP), previously called as East Turkestan Islamic Movement (ETIM), blamed by Beijing for unrest in Xinjiang.
- Beijing also continues to worry about instability spreading from Afghanistan into South and Central Asia, where China has significant economic and political interests.
- China's economic interest in the mineral resources of Afghanistan like Iron, Copper, Lithium, Coal etc.
- Greater Chinese influence in Afghanistan with demonstrate its acceptability and soft power beyond its proximity give it upper hand vis-à-vis USA.

Bangladesh

Bangladesh came into existence as a result of refusal of the Pakistani military junta to transfer power to the Awami League led by Sheikh Mujibur Rahman. This led to the 1971 Bangladesh genocide and the massacre of pro-independence Bengali civilians, including intellectuals. In the Bangladesh Liberation War, 1971, the Mukti Bahini aided by India waged a guerrilla war and creation of Bangladesh.



The new state of Bangladesh became constitutionally secular state in 1972. In 1977, secularism was removed from constitution by Martial law. Islam was declared the state religion by Bangladesh Parliament in 1988. In 2010, the Bangladesh Supreme Court reaffirmed secular principles in the constitution.

India Bangladesh Relations

India shares its longest border of 4,096.7 kilometres with Bangladesh. Both nations share bonds of history, language, culture, and multitude of other commonalities. India was the first nation to recognize Bangladesh and establish diplomatic relations immediately after its independence in December 1971. The excellent bilateral ties reflect an all-encompassing partnership based on sovereignty, equality, trust and understanding that goes far beyond a strategic partnership. However, Dhaka's approach towards India has varied over time and under different regimes. Under Awami League government, relations have been positive. But more nationalist

governments and military regimes have attempted to balance against India. Sometimes efforts have been made to destabilize India along Bangladesh border and deepen military and economic ties with China and Pakistan.

Both nations are members of SAARC, BIMSTEC, IORA and the commonwealth.

Significance of Bangladesh:

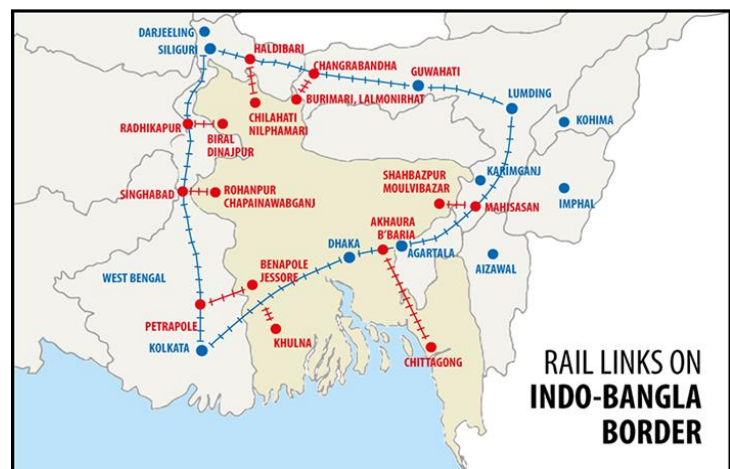
1. Bangladesh is the key to success of Neighbourhood First Policy and Act East policy.
2. Important for success of BIMSTEC, BBIN initiative etc.
3. Key to development and security of North East
4. Partner in fight against terrorism and radicalisation in the region.
5. Ensuring maritime security in Bay of Bengal
6. Cooperation necessary for limiting Chinese adventurism in the region

Economic Relations:

- Bangladesh is India's biggest trade partner in South Asia with bilateral trade volume of around \$16 billion. India's exports to Bangladesh are at \$14 billion and imports at \$2 billion.
- Bangladesh enjoys Duty-Free and Quota Free access for exports to India under South Asian Free Trade Area (SAFTA) since 2011. In December 2020, to further boost the bilateral trade cooperation, an **India-Bangladesh CEO's Forum** was launched.
- India has extended 3 Lines of Credits (LOC) to Bangladesh in the last 8 years amounting to \$8 billion for development of infrastructure in sectors including roads, railways, shipping and ports.
- In July 2023, India and Bangladesh launched trade transaction in rupee aimed at reducing dependence on US dollars and strengthen regional currency and trade.

Connectivity:

- After the Partition in 1947, seven rail links were operational between India and Bangladesh (then East Pakistan) until 1965.
- Presently, five rail links between Bangladesh and India are operational. They are Petrapole (India)-Benapole (Bangladesh), Gede (India)-Darshana (Bangladesh), Singhabad (India)-Rohanpur (Bangladesh), Radhikapur (India)-Biraj (Bangladesh), Haldibari (India)-Chilahati (Bangladesh).



- Government of India has also been providing grant assistance to Bangladesh for various infrastructure projects including construction of **Akhaura-Agartala rail link**, **dredging of**

inland waterways in Bangladesh and construction of **India-Bangladesh Friendship Pipeline**.

Security Cooperation:

1. Bangladesh helped in arresting top leadership of ULFA and NDFB.
2. Bilateral Exercise: SAMPRITI between the two Armies.
3. \$500 million line of credit for purchasing defence equipments.
4. Regular meetings between BSF and BGB to tackle trafficking and illegal migration.

Assam centric
insurgent
group

Border dispute is due to demography
change.

Energy Cooperation:

1. Agreement to export Energy to Bangladesh from Tripura.
2. India-Bangladesh Friendship Pipeline from Siliguri to Parbatipur in Bangladesh for supply of high speed diesel.
3. Trilateral cooperation between India, Bangladesh and Russia for construction and installation of Rooppur nuclear power plant.

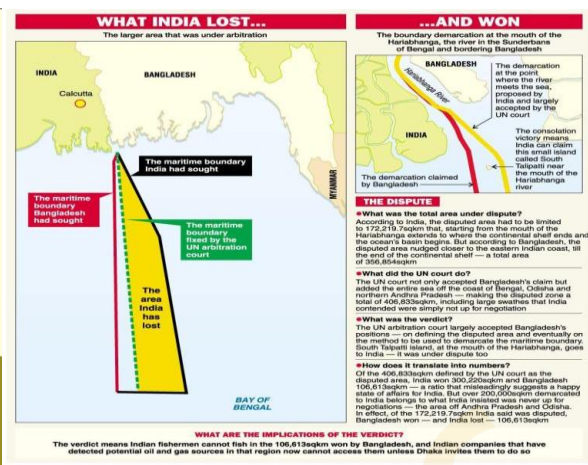
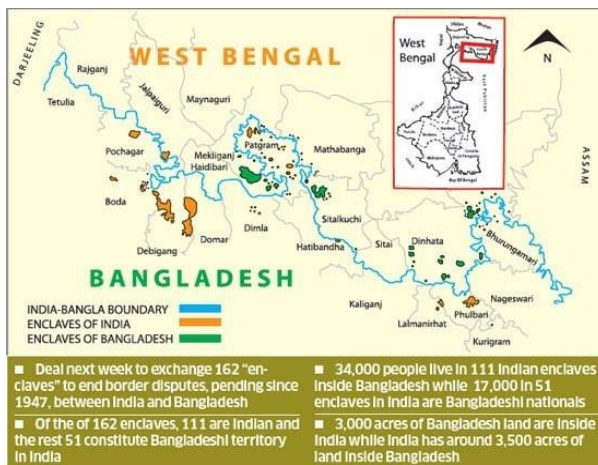
Other Initiatives:

- **High Impact Community Development Projects (HICDPs)** constitute an active pillar of India's development assistance. The Government of India has funded 68 HICDPs including construction of student hostels, academic buildings, skill development and training institutes, cultural centers, and orphanages etc in Bangladesh and another 16 HICDPs are being implemented.
- Both nations have signed agreement allowing India to use the Chattogram and Mongla ports in Bangladesh for movement of goods to and from India, particularly from North-eastern India.
- Use of Bangladesh's Feni River for drinking water supply in Tripura.
- India and Bangladesh have agreed to expand cooperation across the entire gamut of water resources issues, including framework for sharing of river waters, mitigation of pollution, river bank protection, flood management and basin management.

Chittagoram

Recent Initiatives:

- Resolution of land boundary and maritime dispute:
 - The 2011 protocol called for swap of 111 Indian enclaves in Bangladesh with 51 Bangladesh enclaves in India. This was ratified by Indian parliament in May 2015 through 100th constitutional amendment.
 - In July 2014, the UN tribunal awarded four-fifth of total disputed area of 25,602 sq. km in the Bay of Bengal to Bangladesh.



- Support during Covid-19: India gifted 109 ambulances and 1.2 million Covid-vaccine doses, the biggest recipient of Made-in-India Covid-19 vaccine doses, accounting for 16% of the total supplies.
- India and Bangladesh have agreed for simultaneous coordinated patrols by BSF and BGB (Border Guard Bangladesh) and enhance information-sharing to check trans-border crimes.
- Out of total 4,096.7 km of border, 3,141 km Border Fencing has been done.

Teesta River Issue:

Teesta river is a tributary of Jamuna River (Brahmaputra) originating in Sikkim and entering Bangladesh after crossing West Bengal.

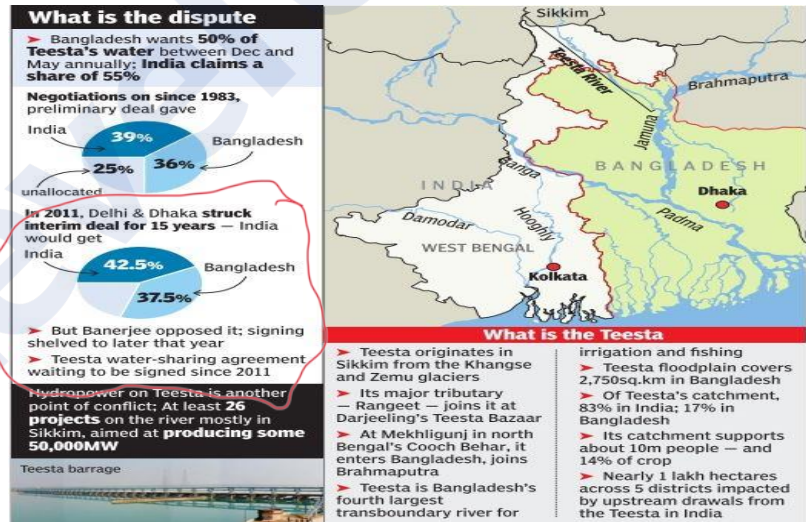
Importance for Bangladesh: It covers about 14 per cent of the total cropped area and about 7.3 per cent of the Bangladesh population relies on the river for direct livelihood.

Importance For West Bengal:

The river is important to sustain

its five northern districts of Darjeeling, North and South Dinajpur, Cooch Behar and Jalpaiguri, which happen to be some of the poorest farming districts in West Bengal representing an approximate 12.77 per cent of the total state population.

- It is a highly politically charged topic in Bangladesh which is often an election issue raised by both the main national parties.
- Bangladesh sought a fair and equitable distribution of Teesta waters from India, on the lines of the Ganga Water Treaty 1996.



3. A 2011 interim deal – that was supposed to last 15 years – gave India 42.5 percent of the Teesta's waters and gave Bangladesh 37.5 percent. West Bengal and Sikkim opposed this deal so it was shelved and remains unsigned.

West Bengal Suggestion:

- West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee has proposed sharing the waters of the Torsa, Jaldhaka and Raidak rivers instead. The Torsa has connectivity with Bangladesh's Padma.
- It has proposed that the two countries set up a commission to ascertain the level of water flowing through the Torsa and the quantum of water that can be shared.

India and Bangladesh share 54 transboundary rivers. So, a holistic planning and cooperation covering all rivers can be a win-win proposition.

Other Challenges:

1. Border issues: Illegal migration, Human and animal trafficking, border killings remain a challenge to the relationship.
2. Challenges due to CAA and NRC: CAA and NRC had been seen with scepticism by Bangladesh as targeted towards it.
3. Political Rhetoric within India aimed at Bangladesh cause unnecessary frictions to the relationship.
4. Increasing radicalisation within Bangladesh, targeting of Hindu places of worship, activities of Jamaat-e-Islami Bangladesh (JMB) are other areas of concern.
5. China factor: Deepening of Bangladesh-China military cooperation is another challenge to the relationship.

Avenues for Cooperation

1. Coordinating on Brahmaputra: Both nations can coordinate on maintaining Brahmaputra River and resisting China's unilateral designs over it.
2. Tackling Radicalisation: Since radicalisation remains a threat, that can be an area of cooperation. In November 2015, Bangladesh handed over top ULFA leader Anup Chetia to India.
3. Economic cooperation can be another area of cooperation due to economic complementarities.
4. Climate change: As both India and Bangladesh face threat of climate change, this can be another area of cooperation.

*Radicalisation / terrorism with every nation except Afghanistan.
climate change*

China-Bangladesh Relations:

- China is Bangladesh's biggest trade partner with over \$25 billion. The trade balance is heavily tilted in favour of China.
- In August 2022, China announced duty-free access to 99% of Bangladeshi products w.e.f. 1st September 2022.

- China is among the major investor in Bangladesh in sectors like energy and infrastructure. However, joint investments like Payra Power Plant has been performing sub-optimally and is a stumbling block in repayment of Chinese loans.
- China and Bangladesh has significant military cooperation with Chinese platforms like frigates, missile boats and fighter jets. In 2002, China and Bangladesh signed a "Defence Cooperation Agreement" which covers military training and defence production.
- In 2016, Bangladesh bought two Chinese refurbished submarines.



Sri Lanka

It lies in the Indian Ocean, southwest of the Bay of Bengal, separated from the Indian peninsula by the Gulf of Mannar and the Palk Strait. Sri Lanka shares a maritime border with the Maldives in the south-west and India in the north-west.

Facts about Sri Lanka:

- Population: 22 million (2020)
- Economy: \$75.3 Billion (Nominal)
- Demography: 74.9% Sinhalese, 11.2% Sri Lankan Tamils, 9.2% Sri Lankan Moors, 4.2% Indian Tamils
- Religion: 70.2% Buddhism, 12.6% Hinduism, 9.7% Islam, 7.4% Christianity.

Buddhist

Tamil

Sri Lanka got independence from British in 1948. After independence, there were multiple conflicts between Sinhala majority and Tamil minority in 1956, 1958, 1977, 1981 and 1983.

Civil War
Sri Lanka
LTTE

Origins of the Sri Lankan Civil War

The ethnic composition of Sri Lanka has played a significant role in the country's history and politics. The Sinhalese, who form the majority of the population, migrated from **northern India around the 500s BC**. They maintained contacts with the Tamils, who were settled in the southern part of the Indian subcontinent. Major migrations of Tamils to Sri Lanka occurred between the 7th and 11th centuries CE.

During the British rule from 1815 to 1948, close to a million Tamils were brought in to work in the coffee, tea and rubber plantations. The British also established educational and other infrastructures predominantly in the Tamil-majority northern parts of the country, which led to a sense of resentment among the Sinhalese population.

Post 1956 election, **Sinhala Only Act** displaced English as the medium of administration and legal usage. As a result, in 1956, 30 percent of the Ceylon administrative service, 50 percent of the clerical service, 60 percent of engineers and doctors, and 40 percent of the armed forces were Tamil. By 1970 those numbers had plummeted to 5 percent, 5 percent, 10 percent, and 1 percent, respectively. After a long bitter struggle, the Sinhala Only Act was watered down and Tamil was also recognized in 1958. Presently, both Sinhala and Tamil are official languages of administration and legislation in Sri Lanka.

Furthermore, there was Continued persecution of the Tamil population and Tamil identity with impunity from the state. This resulted in emergence of **Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam (LTTE) as defender of Tamils**. They believed that the only true way that the two races could exist would be for two entirely sovereign nations to be created.



LTTE Insignia

The LTTE was established in 1976 by Prabhakaran with the objective of creating a separate homeland for Tamils in the northern and eastern parts of Sri Lanka. Their first major attack occurred in July 1983, escalating the conflict. The LTTE gradually consolidated its position as the sole representative of the Sri Lankan Tamils, even capturing Jaffna in 1986.

In 1987, faced with growing anger amongst its own Tamils, concerns about separatism in Tamil Nadu, and a flood of refugees, India intervened directly in the conflict for the

first time after the Sri Lankan government attempted to regain control of the northern Jaffna region by means of an economic blockade and military assaults under **Operation Vadamarachchi**. India supplied food and medicine by air and sea under **Operation Poomalai**.

This forced the Sri Lankan government to accept the Indian proposal and Indo-Sri Lanka Peace Accord (Rajiv Jayewardene Accord) was signed between Indian Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi and Sri Lankan President J R Jayewardene. The accord was expected to resolve the Sri Lankan Civil War by enabling the **thirteenth Amendment to the Constitution of Sri Lanka** and the Provincial Councils Act of 1987. Under the terms of the agreement, Colombo agreed to a devolution of power to the provinces, the Sri Lankan troops were to be withdrawn to their barracks in the north and the Tamil rebels were to surrender their arms.

However, the LTTE had not been made party to the talks and initially agreed to surrender their arms to the Indian Peace Keeping Force (IPKF) only reluctantly. Within a few months however, this flared into an active confrontation. The LTTE declared their intent to continue the armed struggle for an independent Tamil Eelam and refused to disarm. The IPKF found itself engaged in a bloody police action against the LTTE.

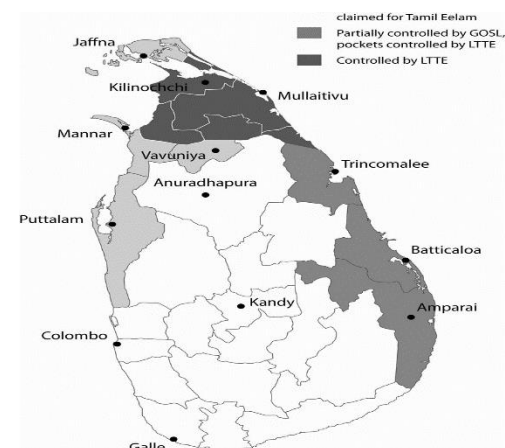
Indo- Sri Lanka Accord/Rajiv Jayavardhane Accord:

The Indo-Sri Lanka Peace Accord was an accord signed in Colombo on 29 July 1987.

1. Sri Lankan Government made a number of concessions to Tamil demands, which included Colombo's



LTTE Chief V Prabhakaran



Area of LTTE influence



Not Party
LTTE
should have
been

devolution of power to the provinces, merger (subject to later referendum) of the northern and eastern provinces, and official status for the Tamil language.

2. Sri Lankan troops were to withdraw to their barracks in the north, the Tamil rebels were to disarm. India agreed to end support for the Tamil separatist movement and recognise the unity of Sri Lanka.
3. IPKF was deployed to maintain peace in the region. However, the mission failed.

In 1990, India withdrew the last of its forces from Sri Lanka, and fighting between the LTTE and the government resumed.

The final phase of the civil war, from 2008 to 2009, was marked by intense military offensives by the Sri Lankan government against the LTTE-held territories. The conflict culminated in the defeat of the LTTE in May 2009. The final stages of the war were characterized by significant humanitarian concerns. There were reports of civilian casualties, displacement, and allegations of human rights abuses by both sides.

The end of the civil war marked a turning point in Sri Lanka's history, but it also left a legacy of trauma and challenges. Reconciliation efforts, demilitarization, and addressing the grievances of the Tamil population became critical tasks for the post-war government. The government faced international scrutiny for alleged human rights violations during the conflict's final stages. Calls for accountability and justice persist.

Significance of Sri Lanka for India:

1. Geopolitical: Maintaining India's primacy in the Indian Ocean Region, limiting Chinese designs in the IOR.
2. Economic: Investment opportunity in cooperation with third country (Japan), safety of trade routes, market for Indian goods.
3. Security: Safety of sea lanes of communication, Stability in south India, especially Tamil Nadu, tackling radicalism.
4. Shared concern about climate change, global warming, and natural disasters
5. Cultural: Tamil, Buddhism

India Sri Lanka Relations

India and Sri Lanka have a legacy of intellectual, cultural, religious and linguistic interaction and the relationship between two countries is more than 2500 years old.

Economic Relations:

India was *Sri Lanka's* largest **trading** partner with an overall **bilateral** merchandise **trade** of US\$ 6.18 billion in 2022-23. India's export in 2022-23 was at \$5.11 billion and imports from Sri Lanka at \$1.07 billion. India-Sri Lanka Free Trade Agreement (ISFTA) signed in year 2000 contributed significantly towards the expansion of trade between the two countries.

India has traditionally been among Sri Lanka's largest trade partners and Sri Lanka remains among the largest trade partners of India in the SAARC. India has been the largest source market of tourists visiting Sri Lanka, prior to the pandemic.

India and Sri Lanka have resumed talks for an **Economic and Technology Cooperation Agreement (ETCA)** after a gap of nearly five years. There had been 11-round of talks from 2016 to 2018 and then it was paused.

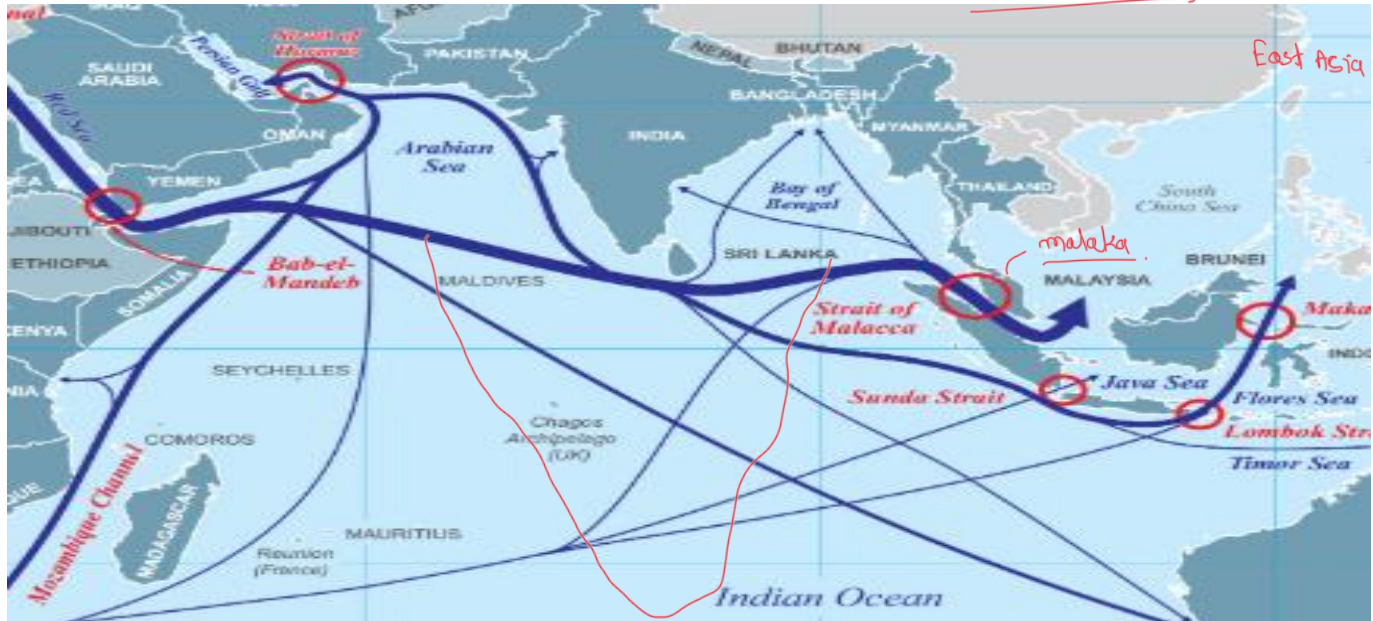
Reducing dollar dependency.

internationalization of Rupee

18 country

Sri Lanka has designated **Indian Rupee as designated foreign currency** for bilateral trade.

Suez canal
Arabian Peninsula
(energy)



Security Cooperation:

1. India and Sri Lanka regularly engage in maritime dialogue under the 'India- Sri Lanka- Maldives' trilateral mechanism. NSA visited Sri Lanka in November 2020 to attend the fourth maritime dialogue.
2. In April 2022, India and Sri Lanka entered into maritime security agreement for a **joint Maritime Rescue Coordination Centre (MRCC)**.
3. India-Sri Lanka annual defence dialogue. Its seventh meeting took place in February 2023 where both sides agreed to increase the intensity of bilateral military exercises.
4. India has offered Sri Lanka with Dornier surveillance aircraft and indigenously constructed Offshore Patrol Vessels (OPVs) to meet its immediate security requirement.
5. Mitra Shakti bilateral Military exercise.
6. SLINEX Maritime exercise.

Development Cooperation:

Sri Lanka is one of India's major development partners. India's development cooperation portfolio stands at around USD 5 billion, with close to USD 600 million being in grants.

Demand- driven and people-centric nature of India's development partnership with Sri Lanka have been the cornerstone of this relationship.

India's commitment under **Indian Housing Project stand at 60,000 with 46,000 already completed.** Under **phase IV**, India will be building 10,000 houses in the plantation area, spread across 11 districts and 6 provinces of Sri Lanka. Grant projects cut across sectors such as education, health, livelihood, housing, industrial development etc. under these LOCs include: Railway, transport, connectivity, defence, solar.

Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation (ITEC) Scheme and the Colombo Plan, Sri Lankan nationals can benefit from 400 slots for short- and medium-term training courses in a variety of technical and professional disciplines.

Recent Issues:

1. Since coming of Rajapaksa regime, Sri Lanka went back closer to China. But India's assistance during economic crisis has brought both nations together.
2. In February, Sri Lanka backed out from a tripartite partnership with India and Japan for its East Container Terminal Project at the Colombo Port, citing domestic issues. However, the West Coast Terminal was offered later on under a public private partnership arrangement.
3. Continued docking of Chinese ships on Sri Lankan ports. In August 2023, China's satellite tracking vessel Yuan Wang 5 arrived at Hambantota port, leading to diplomatic tensions.
4. Increasing centralisation goes against the spirit of 13th amendment.

desolution of power to the provinces. has promise under 13th Amendment has not yet taken place.

Positives:

1. China has been replaced from Hybrid energy project to be constructed in three Islands of Jaffna, which is closer to India. It will be done by India. This will be the third Indian energy project coming up in Sri Lanka's north and East.
2. Cooperation on Trincomalee Oil container terminal: India and Sri Lanka agreed to develop Trincomalee city in the island nation as a regional hub.
3. Cultural exchanges: Direct flight from Colombo to Kushinagar.
4. India's support to Sri Lanka during the economic crisis and ongoing negotiations with its creditors and the IMF.

80% buddhist maha parinirvan

Scope for Cooperation:

1. **Tackling economic challenges:** With largest economy in the region, India can play central role in Sri Lanka's economic revival and diversification.
2. **Tackling radicalisation:** Since both India and Sri Lanka have faced the brunt of radicalisation (Easter Bombings, 26/11 attacks), both have shared stake in tackling it.
3. **Safety of SLoC:** Being maritime nations and along the critical Sea Lanes of Communications (SLOC), it provides avenue for cooperation.

4. **Climate change and rise in sea level** presents greater threat to Sri Lanka, being an island nation. India at the forefront of fighting climate change, can guide Sri Lanka in its technological and economic reorientation in this regard.

Challenges:

Tamil fishermen rich, equipments boat.

- **Fishermen Issue:** The issue of fishermen from both countries crossing maritime boundaries and engaging in illegal, unreported, and unregulated (IUU) fishing activities has been a persistent challenge. This has led to arrests and occasional confrontations, affecting the livelihoods of fishermen on both sides.
- **Economic Relations and Trade Imbalance:** Trade imbalances and restrictions on certain goods have been points of contention. India has expressed concerns about non-tariff barriers and restrictions on its exports to Sri Lanka, while Sri Lanka has sought more favourable trade terms.
- **China's influence:** Sri Lanka's growing economic and strategic ties with China have been a concern for India. Chinese investments in Sri Lankan infrastructure projects, including the Hambantota Port, have raised geopolitical apprehensions.
- **Ethnic and Political Issues:** The historical ethnic conflict in Sri Lanka, particularly concerns related to the Tamil minority, has at times created sensitivities in India-Sri Lanka relations. India has expressed interest in the reconciliation process and the political empowerment of Tamils.
- **Port Development and Strategic Concerns:** The development of strategic ports in Sri Lanka, such as Hambantota and Colombo, has raised strategic concerns for India. There have been apprehensions about the potential military use of these ports by external powers, impacting India's security interests. *ex Hambantota Port.*
- **Regional Diplomacy:** Both countries are active members of regional organizations like SAARC (South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation) and BIMSTEC (Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation). Differences in approaches or priorities within these forums can pose challenges to collaboration.

Why China?

1. **Balancing India:** Being a smaller nation neighbouring a much powerful India, Sri Lanka looks at extra-regional powers like China to balance India in the region.
2. **Funds and economic support:** China have deep pockets and provides funds quickly, there are delays by India in providing funds and support.
3. **Concerns about India interference:** There have been concerns about India's interference in Sri Lanka's domestic politics. Ex-PM Mahinda Rajapaksa has accused Indian intelligence agencies behind his defeat in the elections.
4. **Support of China at UN:** China being a P-5 member, has frequently supported Sri Lanka against western criticism over war-time atrocities and human rights violations.

Sri Lanka economic crisis:

Sri Lanka underwent its worst economic crisis since independence in recent times due to multiple factors. It has led to unprecedented levels of inflation, near-depletion of foreign exchange reserves, shortages of medical supplies, and an increase in prices of basic commodities. It had to declare a sovereign default. It had to put multiple restrictions to save fuel and reduce unnecessary imports. India provided the economic lifeline in the form of Line of Credit amounting to \$4 Billion. It is negotiating with IMF for a bailout package and debt restructuring with creditors.

default
no money

Reasons:

1. **Lack of economic reforms** has limited the export earnings and made it dependent on borrowings.
 2. **Fiscal mismanagement:** Populist agenda of tax cuts by Rajapaksa regime led to budget deficit soaring from 5% in 2020 to 15% in 2022.
 3. **Unsustainable debts:** Sri Lanka's total debt is around \$36.6 billion, with China as its biggest creditor. White elephant projects like Hambantota port have not taken off.
 4. **Covid-19 crisis:** This put a pause on tourism, which accounts for 10% of Sri Lanka's GDP.
 5. **Change in agricultural policy:** sudden nationwide ban on chemical fertilizers and pesticides in June 2021 resulted in collapse of agriculture.
 6. **Ukraine crisis** and resultant spike in energy prices
 7. Lack of proactive decision making
- India has provided \$4 billion of support in form of aid, line of credit and credit swap facility.
 - On the sidelines of QUAD meeting in Tokyo, India and Japan agreed to help Sri Lanka in current economic and humanitarian crisis. India along with Japan and France has helped Sri Lanka in reaching debt restructuring.
 - India has also supported Sri Lanka in its negotiations with the IMF.

Opportunities for India:

1. India's timely help has boosted India's image among Sri Lankan people as a friendly nation coming forward in the time of crisis.
2. India has also signed agreements related to Trincomalee oil tank farm, three major power projects and maritime security pact.
3. The crisis has exposed the nature of Chinese debt and its unsustainability not only for Sri Lanka but other nations in the region too.
4. It can strengthen India's image as a helpful elder brother for the smaller neighbours and give a fillip to Neighbourhood First Policy.
5. Thus, timely positive interventions in the times of crisis can strengthen India's leadership credentials and help in regaining the lost ground in its own strategic backyard from China.

Challenges:

1. India's past image of interfering in Sri Lanka's internal affairs.
2. India's limited financial capacity to help Sri Lanka.
3. Lack of discussions on implementing 13th amendment, which has been a stumbling block in India- Sri Lanka relations.
4. Spillover of refugees to India.
5. Protests in Sri Lanka over Maritime Security pact and power projects.

Suggestions:

- Short Term: Getting support from IMF and other nations, attracting tourism, line of credit for fuel from energy exporting nations
- Long Term: Economic reforms, diversification of exports, Choosing financially viable debts.

Sri Lanka 21st Constitutional Amendment:

Diluting the powers of the President reinstated through 20th amendment, Sri Lanka parliament passed 21st Constitutional amendment to trim the powers of the President and empower the Parliament. Under the 21A, the President will be held accountable to the Parliament. The Cabinet of Ministers will also be also accountable to Parliament. The National Council will also accountable to Parliament. Fifteen Committees and Oversight Committees will be accountable to Parliament.

10th amendment

Q. How domestic factor influence foreign Policy

India's

① Tamil factor

② India's intervention in SL

Sri Lanka's

Rajapaksa regime

Closer to China

any domestic factor bound to influence the foreign policy, but must be based on broader national interest rather than narrow self interest